PATRICK IBER

SYLLABUS: MODERN LATIN AMERICA, 2021

January 5, 2021 in uncategorized · Latin America, syllabi, teaching

History 242

University of Wisconsin, Madison

Modern Latin America

Professor Patrick Iber

Fall 2021 / MWF 9:50-10:45, online

Friday can be asynchronous

This course will give a broad overview of Latin American history in the modern period, since independence but with a primary focus on the twentieth century. Particular emphasis will be placed on the socioeconomic, cultural, and political structures and processes that shaped and continue to influence life in Latin America. Key issues such as colonialism, nationalism, democracy, and revolution will be examined critically in order to understand the roots of the contemporary political and economic crisis. We will also try to explore in detail sol for the Mexican and Cuban revolutions, populism and dictatorship, socialism and neoliberalism, and drugs and migration.

COURSE TEXT

Virginia Garrard, Peter Henderson and Bryan McCann, *Latin America in the Modern World*, (New York: Oxford University Press, 2019), ISBN-9780190925329, $38.95 (Ebook available at $19.99.)

All other readings will be provided in PDF format.

The primary goals of this course are that students will be able to

- Describe the contours of Latin American history in the period since independence,
- Apply and use key concepts relevant to Latin American history, such as imperialism, inequality, populism, socialism, neoliberalism,
- Read for a dedicated purpose across different genres and forms of writing,
- Apply historical reasoning to understanding the origins of present day issues,
- Communicate effectively through presentations, discussion, and written work.

Close Format and Structure

This class takes place in its own moment in history: that marked by, among other things, the broad disruption to normal ways of living brought about by COVID-19. Given that reality, we can't have a standard class. But we can still have an excellent one, and I have made every effort to think about how to provide you with the best possible experience under these conditions. It also means that I will be very flexible. If, for whatever reason, you are unable to meet the standard expectations, if you are not able to do a given assignment, you can create an alternative, equivalent assignment. If you fall behind (because you fall ill, for example), you can catch up on your own schedule. THE MOST IMPORTANT THING THIS SEMESTER IS FOR YOU TO STAY HEALTHY AND SAFE, AND I WILL NOT BE LEARNING AS MUCH AS YOU CAN, LA or any class, keep the focus on what matters most.

Every week will have four elements:

GRADING INFORMATION

Grades are often thought of as a way of measuring the quality of student work, or even of the quality of the student themselves. But COVID-19 has made it especially clear that grades also depend on many extraneous factors outside of the student's control. This has always been true, but is particularly clear now. Under these conditions, I have decided to participate in an experiment in partial pre-grading. This is a practice that has been adopted by a small but growing number of instructors, frustrated that standard grading often seems to mistake learning other things for quality. It has also been my hard work, initiative, focus, drive, and practice. I also believe in creativity, exploration, and in the possibilities of diverse approaches to demonstrating mastery. The bottom line is that this semester you will compile a portfolio of your work from the semester, and then supply your own final grade by using a flowchart and a combination of assessment and self-assessment. Though I reserve the right to challenge or change your grade, I don't anticipate that this will be a common practice.

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At the University of Wisconsin, I believe that letter grades should mean the following:

- A indicates really superlative work. The student has not only mastered the material in the course at a high level, but has taken the initiative to go above and beyond course requirements.
- AB indicates the student has mastered the material in the course at a high level. The student has done the reading and writing, participated actively in discussion and lecture, and can show that they have grasped the essential concepts and made an effort to improve and develop fundamental skills.
- B indicates that the student has understood most of the course material. The student has done most of the reading and writing for the class, and participated in most discussions. The student can show that they engaged with the class thoughtfully, but may not have mastered a few significant areas, because of time constraints or other reasons.
- BC indicates that the student has understood some of the course material. The student has done some of the reading and writing, but the work may struggle to show demonstrate learning and mastery.
- C indicates that the student has been able to complete some of the course material, but can demonstrate only a modest amount of learning.
- D indicates that the student has been able to complete only a portion of the course work, and therefore to demonstrate only minimal learning.
- F indicates that the student has not been able to complete course work.

Guide to compiling your portfolio

The digital portfolio of your work this semester consists of:

- A cover page
  - On a single page, a summary of your scores on the three quizzes. If you want to add any discussion of the results, you may do so.
  - On a separate page, a summary of your participation in class and section. Please list all of the days of section that you attended, and all of them that you missed. If you missed any, explain why. Then describe your participation and participation in section. Did you do all of the reading? Did you contribute your ideas to the discussion? Did you learn from your peers? Were you respectful to others? This can be just a paragraph or two. You can discuss struggles, progress, moments of insight or helpfulness, and so on. After your last section meeting, email your TA with this description and a place yourself on the rubric found below. The TA can adjust the grade up or down if necessary.
  - A revised version of the essays you chose, based on feedback from your instructors. Please also include the original version of the essay. Please include a one-paragraph postscript describing what changes you made and how you incorporated feedback, and what you yourself noticed could be improved. A rubric is below.
  - Copies of all of your forum posts, with a calculation of your forum grade, based on the rubric below. You don't need to include your comments.
  - On a separate page, a final self-evaluation. Include a calculation of your numerical grade. If you think that grade fairly reflects your learning this semester, you can leave it at that. If you want to make the case for a different letter grade, make the case, with evidence, as outlined below.
  - If you'd like to provide evidence to support a higher grade than the number indicates, some suggestions are below.

To get a benchmark for your grade, this is where you should start.

Add up the percentage score for each of the three quizzes, your section participation, your forum participation, and your essay. The rubrics for scoring these are provided below. Once these are added up, divide by 4.

The number you get is your benchmark. It gets the conversation started. In general, these numbers can serve as a guide:

A: 94-100

AB: 88-93

B: 83-87

BC: 78-82

C: 70-77

D: 60-69

F: <60

Section participation rubric: *Your attendance in section is critical to your learning this semester.* You'll have a chance to discuss the understanding of the class material, to ask questions, to discuss primary documents, and to interact with your peers. This semester, it's going to be especially important to maintain some community for learning. To get your section grade, this is what you need to do:

Give yourself the following points for attendance:

- 70 points for attending all sections, or missing one
- 60 points for missing 2-3 sections
- 50 points for missing 4-5 sections
- 40 points for missing 6-8 sections
- 30 points for missing more than 8 sections

Exception: If you need to miss more than one section due to illness or another emergency, you can excuse those absences in consultation with the TA or professor.

Thinking about your participation in section on the days you were there over the course of the semester, think about which of these best describes your participation? Active participation doesn't necessarily mean that you need to talk every day, or that you will do better by dominating discussion. If you need to talk a lot, strive to make room for your classmates. If you tend to be quiet, think about how you can find ways to make more active contributions.

- 30 points for coming to section with mastery of the readings, exploring questions rigorously, engaging with others respectfully, which means both listening respectfully and contributing your ideas.
- 25 points for coming to section with strong command of the reading and participating frequently and constructively.
- 20 points for coming to section with a partial command of the reading, contributing when called on.
- 15 points for coming to section without incomplete command of the reading, and thus contributing relatively little to the discussion
- 10 points if you didn't engage with section or were disruptive

Before the portfolio is due, email your self-reflection with a numerical grade to your TA for approval.

Forum participation rubric: *there are 7 forum prompts. Give yourself 12 points for each good quality post that represents a thoughtful effort to complete the assignment fully. Issue points if you don't complete the assignment or included (or was late without an important reason). Give yourself 3 points for each week where you made a comment on another person's post that added to the conversation. Your comments should go beyond "nice post" and they should be constructive rather than critical. asking questions and adding insights from your own studies.* 7 posts plus 3 comments will equal 96 points. Don't give yourself a score over 100.

Essay rubric:

You get points for your first draft, and for your revisions.

- 70 points for a solid, serious first draft (as indicated on the rubric). It doesn't have to be perfect
- 60 points for a solid but late draft, or a draft that doesn't meet several of the goals of the assignment
- 50 points for an essay with serious problems
- 40 points if you don't turn in your essay.

	Argument	Evidence	Structure	Technique
Polished	The argument is clearly stated and is reasonable and thoughtful	The evidence skillfully draws from sources. Quotations support the argument and sources are identified	The structure of the essay, sub-arguments, introduction and conclusion, leads the reader to be convinced of the argument	The essay reads with good rhythm, varied sentence structure, and word choice
Some room for improvement	The main argument is identifiable, though it could be more clearly stated or is only partially true	The evidence presented supports the argument but there may not be enough of it or the sources may not be cared enough or clearly identified	Parts of the essay are well organized, but the body may seem out of order, or it may not flow logically	Some sentences are confusing, but overall the writing is clear
Needs major work	The argument is unclear, unfocused, or unreasonable	The evidence does not support the argument, or doesn't draw from sources	The organization of the essay is so confusing for the reader	The writing has problems that make it hard for the reader to follow

In addition to that, you'll get points for revising your essay in response to feedback.

- 20 points for addressing all of the comments of your grader
- 15 points for addressing most of the comments of your grader
- 10 points for addressing some of the comments of your grader

Add a final 10 points for doing your self-reflection as part of your portfolio page about the essay.

Now you have ten scores. Once you've computed the average, you have a place to begin. If you feel the number you get does not fairly represent the work you've done in class, you can make a case in your portfolio for a different grade. Did you do extra work that isn't captured in the numerical score? Did you find an unusual challenge this semester, causing your grade to suffer in one area, but can demonstrate that you overcame it? Did something else happen that you think I should know about? You don't have to include that evidence and convince us. If you experienced extraordinary or extenuating circumstances this semester, feel free to discuss them. I know you're dealing with a lot. Nevertheless, remember that the letter grade reflects your learning in this class in this semester, so hardship doesn't automatically mean that it's appropriate for you to give yourself a grade that you didn't earn. It does mean that we are unusually flexible. Bottom line: if you accept the grade that corresponds to the numerical score, the grading is straightforward. But the numerical grade is not the final word. It is possible to adjust, with greater adjustments requiring greater justification.

Let's say that you've done well and have a numerical average of 88, but you'd like an A in the class. Show that you've done some extra learning. You could read a book about something related to the course that interests you, and write a short paper about it that connects to our class. You could do a project, such as a podcast or a website, that you do as an art or music project. Of course there is no guarantee to be related to the themes of the class, but you have a lot of flexibility. Feel free to bounce ideas off of your instructors.

COURSE PLAN

Week 1: Introduction

Monday, January 25: Introduction to the course

Wednesday, January 27: The Colonial Heritage

Prologue to Latin America in the Modern World, xxvi-lv

Friday, January 29: Forum post #1: Latin America Today

This week, I want you to find a news source about something happening in Latin America today. This should be a substantial article, not a short one-hit "breaking news." Look for excellent reporting in U.S. newspapers, like the New York Times, or in U.K. newspapers, like the Guardian. Look for a story that you find particularly interesting. Or, if your language skills are sufficient, you can read something in something like the Spanish newspaper El País, or in newspapers in specialized Latin Americanist journals.

Summarize what you the article describes, and what it reveals about what are major issues affecting the lives of people living in Latin America today. What questions does it leave you with?

Week 2: Independence

February 1, Independence Struggles I

Latin America in the Modern World, Chapter 1, "Latin America in the Age of Atlantic Revolution, 1780-1825," 2-33.

February 3, Independence Struggles II

Pamela Murray, *For Glory and Bohar: The Remarkable Life of Manuela Sáenz*, University of Texas Press, 2008, chapters 2 and 3, pp. 27-82.

February 5, Forum post #2: Independence and National Identity

Use https://timemap.net/ (or google.com) to search for a country in Latin America by clicking "Find Events." Find a political moment of art and culture. For now, please focus on material from the 19th century and earlier, not from the 20th century (or now. Please **don't** use the world one of the major Mexican visual artists of the Revolution Diego Rivera, Frida Kahlo, Siqueiros or Orozco because we'll all be taking a look at their work in a couple of weeks.)

Examine what you find. Tell us what country you picked, of course, and about what you found. Some questions that you might want to consider include: What sort of objects have been included to create a story of the nation and a national past? How do the objects presented fit that a dominant narrative of the past? How were they represented? All in all, what can we learn from these collections? You may want to take a screenshot of a particularly interesting object or two and include it in your post.

Week 3: Nineteenth Century II

Monday, February 8: Challenges of Independent States I

Latin America in the Modern World, Chapter 4, "Progress and Modernization: The Elite's Strategy, 1870-1930," 188-227.

Wednesday, February 10: Challenges of Independent States II

Erika Pani, "Liars, Degenerate, and Sovereignty in Civil War Mexico, 1857-1867," *Journal of the Civil War Era*, 7, no. 4 (December 2017): 575-596.

Friday, February 12: Forum post #3

This week, I want you to explore the relationship between economic and geography. Is there a relationship that you can see between major exports and its geographic features. Is there a relationship that you can see between that? What natural endowments have helped shape its economic place in the world? Make sure to check out the pods of your classmates also, to learn more about what they did. Feel free to comment.

This might be a good weeks to make sure you can identify the countries and major cities and geographic features of Latin America, for the upcoming quiz.

Week 4: The Mexican Revolution

Monday, February 15, Mexican Revolution I

Latin America in the Modern World, Chapter 7, "Progress and its Discontents, 1880-1930," 286-320.

Wednesday, February 17: Mexican Revolution II

Paul Gillingham, "Popular and Democratic Ideas in the Mexican Revolution, 1910-1917," in *The Mexican Revolution*, ed. Gillingham and Smilie, (Lincoln: University of Nebraska Press, 2019), 1-32.

Friday, February 19: Forum post #4: Revolutionary Art

Find a piece of art from the Mexican Revolution, and post it to the forum. Tell us what it is, and why you think it's significant. Bonus points if you can find a piece that wasn't already discussed in class.

Week 5: Populism and Revolution

Monday, February 22: Populism I

Latin America in the Modern World, Chapter 8, "Populism and Its Contradictions," 321-357.

Wednesday, February 24: Populism II

Daniel James, "Rhetoric, Regime, and Sovereignty in Perón's First Presidency," *The Hispanic American Historical Review*, 88, no. 2 (May 2008): 273-305.

Friday, February 26: Forum post #5: Populism and Its Contradictions

Latin America in the Modern World, Chapter 8, "Populism and Its Contradictions, 1930-1980," 358-395.

Week 6: The Cuban Revolution

Monday, March 1: The Cuban Revolution I

Latin America in the Modern World, Chapter 9, "Revolution and Its Discontents, 1959-1980," 396-437.

Wednesday, March 3: The Cuban Revolution II

Lillian Guerra, "Early Cuban Socialism and the Stalinist Moment: Anti-Communist Discourse and the Revolutionary Imaginary, 1959-1968," *Journal of Latin American Cultural Studies*, 19, no. 1 (April 2010): 3-22.

Friday, March 5: Forum post #6: Cuban Revolution

Post something you found interesting about the Cuban Revolution.

Week 7: Neoliberalism

Monday, March 8: Neoliberalism I

Latin America in the Modern World, Chapter 10, "Neoliberalism and Its Discontents, 1980-2020," 438-479.

Wednesday, March 10: Neoliberalism II

Alfredo Saad-Filho, "The Political Economy of Neoliberalism in Latin America," in *The Political Economy of Latin America in the Twenty-First Century: Beyond Neoliberalism*, ed. Saad-Filho and Johnston, (London: Routledge, 2005), 1-23.

Friday, March 12: Forum post #7: Neoliberalism

Post something you found interesting about neoliberalism.

Week 8: Populism and Its Contradictions

Monday, March 15: Populism and Its Contradictions I

Latin America in the Modern World, Chapter 11, "Populism and Its Contradictions, 1980-2020," 480-521.

Wednesday, March 17: Populism and Its Contradictions II

Carlos de la Torre, "Populism in Latin America," in *The Oxford Handbook of Populism*, ed. Ostiguy, Panizza, and Moffitt, (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2017), 1-25.

Friday, March 19: Forum post #8: Populism and Its Contradictions

Post something you found interesting about populism.

Week 9: Drugs and Migration

Monday, March 22: Drugs and Migration I

Latin America in the Modern World, Chapter 12, "Drugs and Migration, 1980-2020," 522-563.

Wednesday, March 24: Drugs and Migration II

Eric Zolov, "Discovering the Latin Boom in the United States," in *The Latin Boom: Neoliberalism and Transnational Culture in the 1960s*, ed. Zolov, (Durham: Duke University Press, 2020), 1-29.

Friday, March 26: Forum post #9: Drugs and Migration

Post something you found interesting about drugs or migration.

Week 10: Socialism and Its Contradictions

Monday, March 29: Socialism and Its Contradictions I

Latin America in the Modern World, Chapter 13, "Socialism and Its Contradictions, 1959-2020," 564-607.

Wednesday, March 31: Socialism and Its Contradictions II

Eric Hershberg, "Latin American Left Governments in the Twenty-First Century: Contours of Contestation and Challenges for Critical Research," *Latin American Research Review*, 53, special edition (2018): 7-26.

Friday, April 2: Forum post #10: Socialism and Its Contradictions

Post something you found interesting about socialism.

Week 11: Democracy and Its Discontents

Monday, April 5: Democracy and Its Discontents I

Latin America in the Modern World, Chapter 14, "Democracy and Its Discontents, 1959-2020," 608-651.

Wednesday, April 7: Democracy and Its Discontents II

Kenneth Roberts, "Populism, Polarization, and Illiberal Democracy in Latin America," in *The Resilience of Latin American Neoliberalism*, ed. Lustig, (Washington: Brookings Institution Press, 2020), 1-23.

Friday, April 9: Forum post #11: Democracy and Its Discontents

Post something you found interesting about democracy.

Week 12: Revolution and Its Contradictions

Monday, April 12: Revolution and Its Contradictions I

Latin America in the Modern World, Chapter 15, "Revolution and Its Contradictions, 1959-2020," 652-695.

Wednesday, April 14: Revolution and Its Contradictions II

Steve Ellner, "Latin American Exceptionalism Revisited: Contemporary Venezuela in Comparative Perspective," *Latin American Perspectives*, 47, no. 1 (January 2020): 7-24.

Friday, April 16: Forum post #12: Revolution and Its Contradictions

Post something you found interesting about revolution.

Week 13: Indigenous Rights

Monday, April 19: Indigenous Rights I

Latin America in the Modern World, Chapter 16, "Indigenous Rights, 1959-2020," 696-739.

Wednesday, April 21: Indigenous Rights II

Sarah Chiblow, "Making Neoliberal Subjects: Identity and Indigeneity in Chile's Neoliberal Project," *Latin American Research Review*, 53, special edition (2018): 27-42.

Friday, April 23: Forum post #13: Indigenous Rights

Post something you found interesting about indigeneity.

Week 14: Feminisms

Monday, April 26: Feminisms I

Latin America in the Modern World, Chapter 17, "Feminisms, 1959-2020," 740-783.

Wednesday, April 28: Feminisms II

Millie Thayer, "Feminism Beyond Modernity? Notes on Latin American Feminist Postmodernisms," *Latin American Perspectives*, 27, no. 2 (March 2000): 7-29.

Friday, April 30: Forum post #14: Feminisms

Post something you found interesting about feminism.

Week 15: Conclusions

Monday, May 3: Conclusions I

Latin America in the Modern World, Chapter 18, "Conclusions," 784-827.

Wednesday, May 5: Conclusions II

Eduardo Galeano, "Mirrors," in *Mirrors: Stories of Almost Everyone*, (New York: Picador, 2015), 1-3.

Friday, May 7: Forum post #15: Conclusions

Post something you found interesting about Galeano.

Final Exam: Wednesday, May 12, 10:05-12:05

Wednesday, February 17, Mexican Revolution II

Watch: "The Storm that Swept Mexico," (just the first hour is OK)
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yRNcgGvqGBA&t=8m58s

Friday, February 19: Forum post #4: Arts & the Mexican Revolution

Please watch just a fragment of the second part of the "Storm that Swept Mexico" documentary (or more if you like of course, but the real relevant part is hour 1:20-1:45).

I want you to explore the work of one of the great visual artists of the Mexican Revolution: Diego Rivera, Frida Kahlo, David Alfaro Siqueiros, or José Clemente Orozco. You can find online exhibitions and galleries from museums containing their work at https://artsandculture.google.com by searching for their names. What themes do they highlight? How and where did they paint? In what ways were their lives connected to their artistic projects? In what ways were their artistic projects connected to historical changes that they lived through. You can focus on a particularly compelling work if you like. Include a screenshot and your interpretation of the artwork.

Week 5: Latin America in the World System

February 22, Neocolonialism

Latin America in the Modern World, "Latin America in an Imperial Age," 238-285

Watch: Dee Dee Halleck's film *The Gringo in Mañanaland*

Halleck's film takes clips from newsreels and Hollywood films to show how Latin America was depicted and portrayed—try to think about the relationship of these images to neocolonialism. You can get the idea from the first 15 minutes of the film; you might want to scan a bit after that for sections that interest you.

February 24, The Great Depression

Latin America in the Modern World, parts of chapter 8, 338-381

Angela Vergara, "Chilean Workers and the Great Depression, 1930-1938," pp. 51-80 in Paula Drinot and Alan Knight (eds.), *The Great Depression in Latin America*.

February 26: Quiz #1 (includes map questions)

Week 6: The Cold War

March 1, From World War II to the Cold War: Argentina

Latin America in the Modern World, parts of Chapter 9, 9, 10, "The Great Depression and Authoritarian Populism," 382-539, 616-626, 632-646.

March 3, From World War II to the Cold War: Guatemala

Stephen Kinzer, chapter on Guatemala from *Overthrow*, pp. 129-147.

March 5, Work on Essay

There is no forum post this week. You should work on your essay, which will be due next Friday. Extra professor office hours will be held during the normal class time.

Week 7: The Cuban Revolution

March 8, The Origins of the Cuban Revolution

Latin America in the Modern World, part of Chapter 10, part of "Revolution and Reform in Latin America," 647-656.

Watch: *Fidel Castro*, first hour, https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-8KPfenoI6M

March 10, The Fate of the Cuban Revolution

Deborah Shnookal, chapter on the literacy campaign from *Operation Pedro Pan and the Exodus of Cuba's Children*, pp. 63-104.

Listen audio documentary: Elizabeth Dore, "Cuban Voices," https://www.bbc.co.uk/sounds/play/b06vfyl1

March 12, Essay in Due

This Friday you will be submitting an essay of 1000-1250 words. Your essay should draw from course materials to present an answer to one of the questions provided. You will submit this essay to be read by your instructors, who will provide feedback. You will work on improving your essay, and include both versions in your final portfolio, along with a paragraph discussing what you did to improve the essay.

Week 8: Socialism(s)

March 15, Guerrilla Struggle

Latin America in the Modern World, parts of Chapters 10 and 11, part of "Revolution and Reform in Latin America," 461-500.

Jon Lee Anderson on Che, https://www.theatlantic.com/ideas/archive/guevara-lessons-from-a-revolutionary-life/

Alma Guillermoprieto, "The Heart Angel," from *Looking for History*, 73-86

March 17, Allende's Chile

Peter Winn, "The Fortune of the Andes," from *A Century of Revolution*, pp. 238-275.

Listen to podcast: 99% Invisible on "Project Cybersyn," https://99percentinvisible.org/episode/project-cybersyn/

March 19: Forum post #5: Was Allende's socialism socialism possible?

Choose one of the three parts of Patricio Guzmán's epic documentary, "La Batalla de Chile." Watch at least an hour and a half long, and covers a different aspects of the experience of Chile under Allende. Guzmán, who sympathized with the socialist project, thought he was going to document Chile's transformation. Instead, he ended up documenting polarization, collapse, and the eventual coup d'état.

For this week, pick one of the parts of the documentary:

Part 1: The Insurrection of the Bourgeoisie

Part 2: The Coup d'état

Part 3: Popular Power

Or watch "Chile, Obstinate Memory," a 1997 follow-up in which the filmmaker shows his 1972 movie to Chileans who have never seen it before.

While you watch, the question I want you to ask yourself is whether Chile's socialist project could have survived. If so, how? With what support? With what changes? If not, why not? What made its fall likely, if not inevitable? Use what you in the film as evidence. What sequences and information caused you to come to your conclusion?

Mix it up (politely, respectfully) in the discussion board! It's a hard question to answer.

Week 9: Dictatorship and Democracy

March 22: Pinochet's Chile

Latin America in the Modern World, part of Chapter 11, "Counterrevolution in Latin America, 1965-1985," 501-526.

Watch: "The Chicago Boys," first half: http://www.gentes.cl/2016/05/chicago-boys-vean-aqui-el-documental-que-run-embos-a-la-hora-de-la-comida/

March 24: Transitions to Democracy

Latin America in the Modern World, part of Chapter 13, "Neoliberalism and its Discontents, 1980-2015," 578-600.

Watch: "The Chicago Boys," second half: http://www.gentes.cl/2016/05/chicago-boys-vean-aqui-el-documental-que-run-embos-a-la-hora-de-la-comida/

March 26, Quiz #2

Week 10: The Late Cold War: Central America

March 29, The Wars

Latin America in the Modern World, Chapter 12, "The Late Cold War in Latin America, 1979a-1980," 532-571.

March 31, The Peace

Nobel Prize speech of Oscar Arias of Costa Rica, 1987

https://www.nobelprize.org/prizes/peace/1987/arias/acceptance-speech/

Nobel Peace speech of Guatemalan indigenous activist Rigoberta Menchú Tum, 1992:

https://www.nobelprize.org/prizes/peace/1992/tum/lecture/

The Rigoberta Menchú controversy, 1998:

Oscar Arias looks back on the peace accords:

https://www.washingtonpost.com/lifestyle/style/oscar-arias-sanchez-reflects-on-25-years-since-central-american-peace-accords/2015/08/05/e266ea82-4d88-11e1-a3d2-0d5f8798d3e4_story.html?utm_term=.23c5e0e4ccfe

The Oscar Arias controversy, 2019:

April 2, NO CLASSES, UNIVERSITY HOLIDAY

Week 11: Neoliberalism

April 5, The Washington Consensus

Latin America in the Modern World, part of Chapter 13, "Neoliberalism and its Discontents, 1980-2015," 587-626.

Primary document: Mario Vargas Llosa, "Towards a Totalitarian Peru," 1987, https://www.criterionagazine.com/1987/documentation-toward-a-totalitarian-peru

April 7, Mexico's Transition to Democracy

Latin America in the Modern World 601-626.

Read: Guillermoprieto, "Letter from Mexico City," New Yorker, September 17, 1990

April 9, Forum post #6: Films and contemporary Latin America

Watch one of the films you need to watch a film about relatively contemporary Latin American reality, made by a filmmaker from Latin America. My recommendations are *Amores Perros* (Mexico), *Pizza Birra Faso* (Argentina), *La teta asustada* (Peru), *The Milk of Sorrow* (Peru), *City of God* (Brazil), *Fresa y Chocolate* (Cuba), *Machuca* (Chile), *The Official Story* (Argentina), *The Secret in Their Eyes* (Argentina), but if there's another you're interested in, feel free to clear it with us. In your post, tell us about the movie and how it reflected a moment or place in time. What did it try to tell its viewers? How did it do so?

Week 12: The Pink Tide

April 12: 21st-Century Socialism

Latin America in the Modern World, 626-675.

April 14: 21st-Century Social Democracy

Perspectives on Uruguay:

Eva Fairbanks, https://newrepublic.com/article/120912/uruguays-jose-mujica-was-liberals-dream-too-good-be-true

Gerardo Caetano, https://www.dissentmagazine.org/article/uruguay-the-end-of-the-dream

Nicolas Saldias, https://theglobalsemiperiphery.org/2019/12/the-broad-fronts-legacy-failure-to-reform-uruguays-educational-system/

April 16, Forum post #7

This week, I'd like you to watch Petra Costa, recent documentary "The Edge of Democracy." It's available on Netflix (by which most of you have access) and on Kanopy, which you should all have access to by virtue of being a UW student. The award-winning documentary explores the conditions leading to the fall of the Workers' Party (PT) in Brazil. Write about your reaction to the film. What were the challenges facing the governments of the PT? How well did they navigate them? How would you explain the rise of the right in reaction?

Week 13: Drugs and Violence

April 19: Colombia and Mexico

Guillermoprieto, *Looking for History*, "Our New War in Colombia," 19-39

Eric Meade, Introduction to The Taken: Sue Orlove of the Sinaloa Drug War, pp. 1-52

April 21: The United States

Sam Quinones, *Dreamland*, pp. 258-300

April 23, Quiz #3

Week 14: The Future of Latin America

April 26, Migration

Francisco Cantú, *The Line Becomes a River*, part 3.

April 28, Environment

Paul A. Colinvaux, "The Past and Future Amazon," *Scientific American* 260, no. 5 (May 1989): 102-109.

Ignacio Amigo, "When will the Amazon hit a tipping point?" *Nature*, 25 February 2020,

https://www.nature.com/articles/d41586-020-00508-4

April 30, Compile your portfolios

There are no additional assignments this week: work on compiling your portfolio, as laid out in the syllabus.

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